

Simulated Incident Report — #3

Wazuh / Suricata Detection Lab

01 Alert Summary

INCIDENT #	SIM-003	DATE / TIME	Aug 17, 2026 @ 17:14:50.952
ATTACK TYPE	Malicious File Creation (EICAR Test File)	SEVERITY	Low severity, Rule Level 5
SOURCE	Local file write, /home/ubuntu/Downloads	DESTINATION	54.84.165.65 (VM)
DETECTING TOOL	Wazuh FIM (syscheck), real-time monitoring on /home/ubuntu/Downloads		

02 Initial Triage

Wazuh FIM generated a "file added" event for a new executable-named file in a user's Downloads directory. First questions: was this an expected/authorized download, or unexpected file activity? Filename (invoice_details_urgent.exe) is consistent with common social-engineering/phishing lure naming conventions.

03 Investigation Steps

Confirmed via FIM alert metadata that the file matched the standard EICAR antivirus test signature. Checked whether any other rule groups (network, auth) fired in the same time window to establish a delivery vector with none available, since this lab environment does not include mail gateway or browser-download-source logging. Confirmed the directory (Downloads) is a common landing zone for both legitimate downloads and malicious payloads, underscoring the value of monitoring it.

04 Verdict

TRUE POSITIVE

FALSE POSITIVE

Confirmed malicious file signature (EICAR standard test string) written to disk. Note: this is a controlled/simulated test file, not live malware, used specifically to validate FIM detection without introducing real risk to the lab environment.

05 MITRE ATT&CK

TECH ID#	NAME	TACTIC
T1204.002	User Execution: Malicious File	Execution

06 Escalation

Closed at Tier 1 for this simulated exercise. In a production scenario with a real malicious file (not an EICAR test), this would escalate immediately to Tier 2/IR for containment (host isolation, hash lookup against threat intel, and determining whether the file was executed).

07 Response / Remediation

File removed from the monitored directory. In a live environment: would isolate the host pending investigation, submit the file hash to threat intelligence sources, and check for any execution artifacts (process creation logs) tied to the file.

08 Lessons Learned / Tuning

Default Wazuh configuration did not monitor /home/ubuntu/Downloads, because FIM only covered system paths like /etc or /usr/bin. We added this directory to real-time monitoring to address this visibility gap. User-facing download locations are common landing zones for initial access. Furthermore, Suricata cannot inspect payload content delivered over encrypted HTTPS without TLS interception. This documented blind spot confirms that FIM, rather than network IDS, is the correct detection layer for this scenario.